

i. **Incident 1: Website Down During Peak Hours**

Scenario

E-commerce website is down (P1).

Infra, App, and DB teams are on the bridge.

Teams are arguing → Infra says issue with application, App team blames database.

No one is giving updates.

Client is repeatedly asking for status. MIM's SLA for sending updates every 15 mins is about to break.

--- Challenges

1. Technical teams are blaming each other.
2. No solid update for the client.
3. SLA communications may break.
4. Pressure from leadership and business.

--- How MIM Handles it

1. Bring structure to the call

"Okay team, we will go one by one. Infra, give your status in 30 seconds. App next. DB after that."

2. Assign ownership

"App team, you take primary ownership until RCA is confirmed. Infra, please support."

3. Extract minimum viable update

Even if no RCA, MIM can send:

"Teams are actively engaged."

"Troubleshooting in progress."

"Next update in 15 minutes."

4. Escalate if team is stuck

“App Lead and DB Lead, I need senior SME on the call within 5 minutes.”

5. Protect SLA

Even if no technical progress:

→ Send a process update, not technical.

This keeps SLA intact.

--- Professional Update Example

“Teams are engaged and working on isolating the faulty component. Service remains impacted. Troubleshooting is ongoing with priority. Next update in 15 minutes.”

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🔹 🔹 Incident 2: Database Slowness Impacting All Applications

Scenario

Multiple apps running slow → P1 triggered.

DB Team says: “Issue is not from our side.”

Network Team: “We don’t see anything.”

Application Team says they need logs, but logs are stuck.

Users are disconnected from the system.

MIM needs ETA but teams have no progress.

Challenges

1. No team is accepting ownership.
2. Every team waiting for another team.
3. Client is asking for ETA → no real data.
4. High pressure because multiple apps are impacted.

--- **How MIM Handles It**

1. Force initial owner

“DB team, since the symptoms point to query delays, please take initial ownership until proven otherwise.”

2. Parallel troubleshooting

“Network team, check latency in parallel. App team check thread counts.”

3. Define 5-minute action plans

“Next 5 mins:

DB: Run performance checks

Network: Verify packet drops

App: Capture thread dump”

4. Communicate expectation to teams

“I need updates every 5 mins. If no update, I escalate to senior leadership.”

5. Customer communication

Even without RCA:

“Performance degradation identified. Teams are analyzing DB performance metrics and network path. Next update in 10 minutes.”

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Incident 3: Storage Failure – Servers Unreachable

Scenario

Storage array failure → multiple servers offline.

Storage team is already working on a maintenance activity but says issue is unrelated.

Infra team waiting for confirmation.

Business impact is huge.

Vendor engineer is not joining the call even after multiple pings.

--- Challenges

1. Vendor dependency.

2. Storage team defensive.
3. High downtime risk.
4. No ETA.

--- **How MIM Handles It**

1. Pull vendor into call (force escalation)

Email + call + client manager escalation.

Mark email as SEV1.

2. Put pressure diplomatically

“Storage team, until vendor confirms, we consider storage as potential root cause. Please continue checks.”

3. Parallel actions

“Infra team, work on alternate nodes or DR options.”

4. Communicate smartly

“Major outage identified at storage layer. Vendor engagement ongoing. Working on restoration.”

5. Document impact clearly

Client trusts you more with transparency.

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Incident 4: Network Flap – Frequent Disconnects

Scenario

Users dropping from virtual desktops.

Network device is flapping.

Network team says they need 30 mins to run packet capture.

Client wants updates every 10 mins.

Infra team is frustrated because this keeps happening.

--- **Challenges**

1. Repeated issue → client is angry.
2. Network team needs long time.
3. No immediate fix.
4. MIM needs to keep communication flowing.

--- **How MIM Handles It**

1. Ask for interim workaround

“Network team, can we temporarily shift traffic or reduce load?”

2. Escalate within network team

“Get senior network SME now.”

3. Keep client updated

Even if no fix yet:

“Flapping detected on network segment. Packet capture in progress. Traffic rerouting being evaluated.”

4. Create parallel problem ticket

To show seriousness.

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Incident 5: Application Deployment Failed

Scenario

New deployment pushed.

Application down.

Dev team says: “Rollback is not ready.”

Infra team is waiting.

Client escalation is high.

--- **Challenges**

1. No rollback plan → big governance issue.
2. Dev team not prepared.

3. Pressure from leadership.

4. Business impact is severe.

--- How MIM Handles It

1. Immediate containment

“Infra team, take snapshot / backup.”

2. Force Dev to create rollback plan quickly

“Dev Lead, I need a rollback plan in 5 minutes.”

3. Escalate to Change Manager

Because this is a change failure.

4. Send controlled updates

“Deployment issue identified. Working with Dev team on recovery steps and rollback options.”

5. Keep the call structured and time-boxed

Every 5-minute status.

Scenarios (Different Challenges)

--- Scenario 6: Certificate Expired → Critical API Down

Incident

A critical API stops working.

Downstream apps also fail.

Root cause suspected: certificate expired.

Challenges

1. Security team says certificate renewal takes time.

2. App team has no immediate workaround.

3. Client is losing business.

4. Certificate owner is not reachable.

How MIM handles it

Escalates to security leadership immediately.

Asks Infra & App team to temporarily bypass (if allowed).

Sends short, non-technical updates.

Ensures certificate team joins call ASAP.

Coordinates emergency change to apply new certificate.

--- Scenario 7: Cloud Outage (AWS/Azure) – Partial Region Down

Incident

Cloud provider experiences partial outage.

Apps showing errors intermittently.

Challenges

1. Outage is outside your company's control.
2. Client demands ETA.
3. Cloud support response is slow.
4. Internal teams confused about what to do.

How MIM handles it

Provides client with whatever info is available from cloud status page.

Pushes cloud vendor to join bridge.

Activates DR/Failover plan with Infra team.

Shares clear business impact. Sends updates every 10 minutes even without new RCA.

--- Scenario 8: Firewall Policy Error – Users Unable to Access Application

Incident

After a new firewall rule deployment, many users can't access the app.

Challenges

1. Network team defensive: "Rules are correct."
2. App team says: "No issue from our end."

3. Users are completely blocked.
4. Change team says rollback will take time.

How MIM handles it

Enforces ownership: Network team must validate first.

Requests packet logs + flow checks.

Initiates emergency rollback even if delayed.

Maintains clear, structured updates to client.

Documents it as a change-induced incident.

--- Scenario 9 Storage Space Full – Server Not Booting

Incident

A critical server fails to boot due to disk full.

App hosted on it is completely down.

Challenges

1. Storage team and Infra team blaming each other.
2. No disk cleanup plan ready.
3. Server inaccessible from remote console.
4. Client demanding immediate restoration.

How MIM handles it

Immediately asks Infra to mount disk via rescue mode.

Asks App team to identify safe log files for deletion.

Keeps giving short interval updates.

If delay increases → escalate to leadership.

Once restored → initiate problem ticket.

--- Scenario 10: Queue Build-Up – Payment Processing Delayed

Incident

Payment transactions stuck in queue.

Queue is building rapidly → potential financial loss.

Challenges

1. Messaging team identifies queuing issue but no quick fix.
2. App team wants to restart services but Infra says it may cause more failures.
3. Business team escalating heavily.

How MIM handles it

Forces teams to agree on safe restart window.

Asks App team to partially drain queue.

Sends customer updates focused on impact + actions.

After restoration, requests detailed RCA from Messaging team.

---  Now the Detailed Incident Story (Interview-Ready Answer)

You can speak this as a real-time example in interviews.

--- **DETAILED INCIDENT STORY – MIM Real Time Experience Example**

“One of the major incidents I handled recently was a complete application outage for a financial client during peak business hours.”

1. Incident Trigger

Users were unable to log in.

Monitoring raised multiple critical alerts → P1 declared.

I initiated the bridge and pulled in Infra, App, DB, and Network teams

. --- 2. Challenge: Teams Arguing & No Ownership

App team said: “Database is slow.”

DB team said: “No issue on our side.”

Infra said: “Servers look fine.”

No one accepted ownership.

Client was asking for updates every 15 minutes.

SLA was at risk.

--- 3. My First Action

I brought control to the call:

“Let’s go team by team. I need 30-second status updates. App first, then DB, then Infra.”

This stopped arguments and focused everyone.

--- 4. Assigning Temporary Ownership

Symptoms pointed towards database timeouts, so I said:

“DB team will take initial ownership until confirmed otherwise. Infra and App teams support parallel checks.”

This ensured someone was accountable.

--- 5. Extracting a Useful Update

Even though no RCA was found, I sent:

> “Teams are analyzing database latency and application performance in parallel. Restoration is in progress. Next update in 15 minutes.”

This kept SLA intact without giving wrong information.

--- 6. Challenge: No Progress for 20 Minutes

Teams were stuck. No new logs.

I escalated:

Asked DB team to bring senior SME.

Asked Infra to check system resources.

Asked App team to run thread dump.

--- 7. Breakthrough

Senior DB SME found:

One long-running query locked a major table.

It caused connection timeouts.

DB team killed the session and optimized the query.

--- 8. Service Restored

Within minutes:

Users logged in successfully.

App performance stable.

--- 9. Post-Incident Actions

Sent recovery confirmation to client.

Requested RCA document from DB team.

Opened a problem ticket.

Recommended query optimization and better monitoring alerts.

--- ★ **Short Summary for Interview**

“This incident tested my ability to manage technical conflicts, maintain communication SLAs, and push for ownership. By structuring the call, assigning temporary ownership, escalating SMEs, and maintaining consistent communication, I restored service and prevented SLA breach.”

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